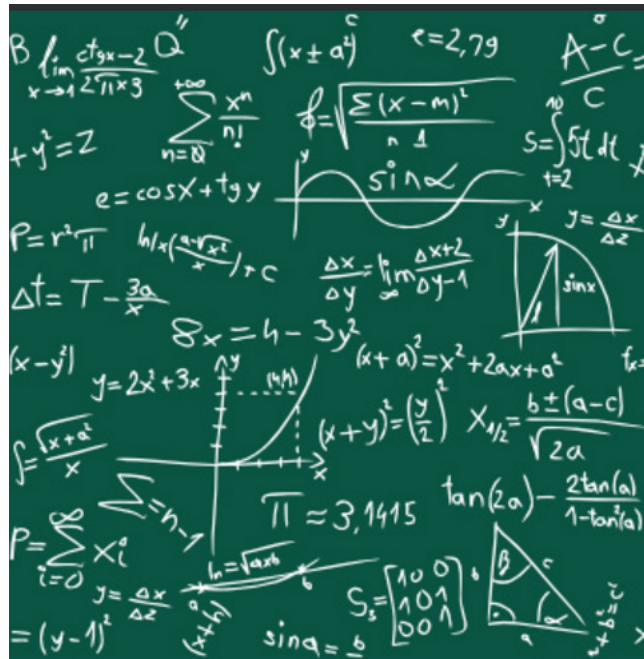


Comparison of infinities



- Author: Fabio Furini.

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1 Comparison of infinities for functions

Theorem 1: Comparison of infinities

Given $\alpha, \beta, \lambda > 0$, $a, b > 1$, we have

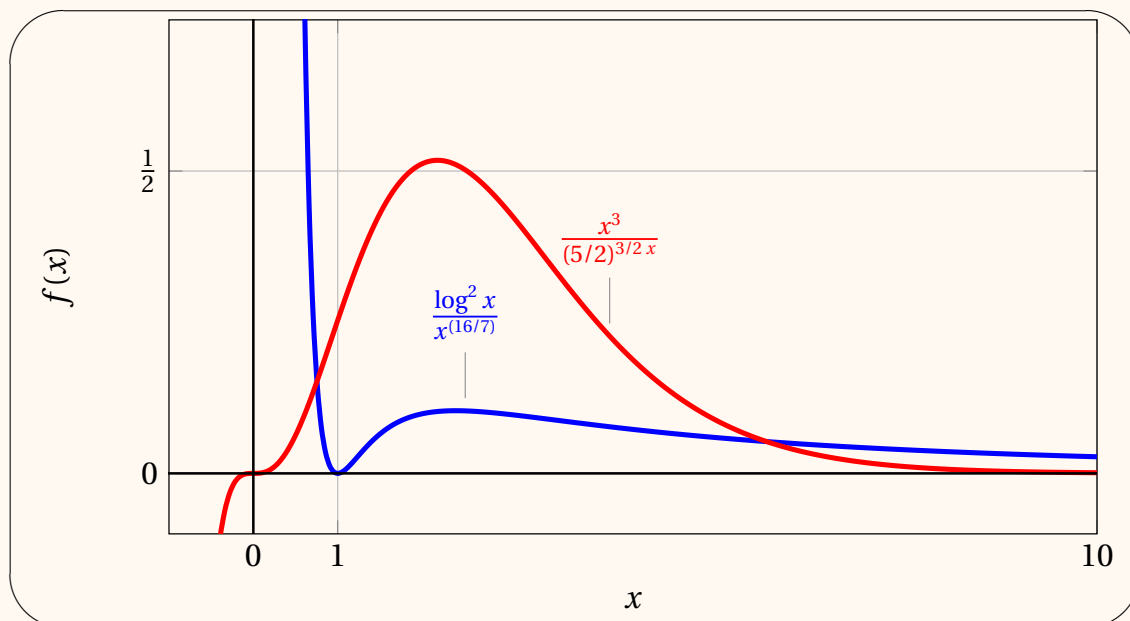
$$\lim_{x \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{\log_a^\beta x}{x^\alpha} = 0 \quad \text{and} \quad \lim_{x \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{x^\alpha}{b^{\lambda x}} = 0$$

Proof. The theorem will be proved with the tools of differential calculus. □

- Any power with positive exponent is an infinity of higher order than any power of logarithms with base > 1 , and
- Any exponential with base > 1 is an infinity of higher order than any power with positive exponent.

Example 1: Comparison of infinities

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{\log^2 x}{x^{(16/7)}} = 0, \quad \lim_{x \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{x^3}{(5/2)^{3/2 x}} = 0$$



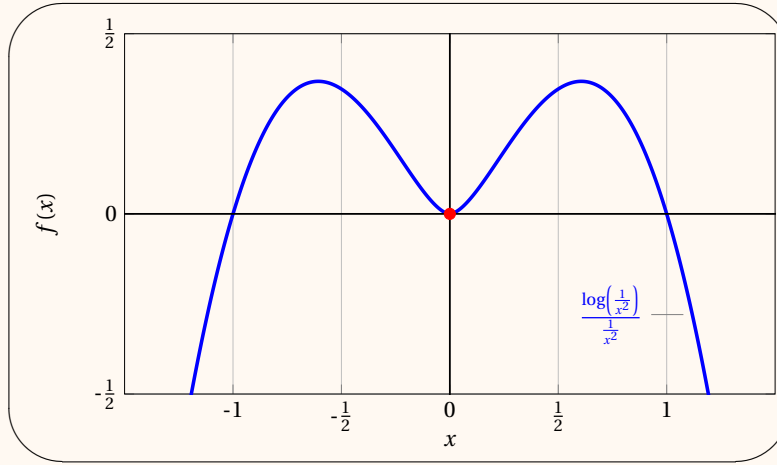
If a function $\eta(x) \rightarrow +\infty$ as $x \rightarrow c \in \mathbb{R}^*$, we have, from the comparison of infinities theorem:

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow c} \frac{(\log_a(\eta(x)))^\beta}{(\eta(x))^\alpha} = 0 \quad \text{and} \quad \lim_{x \rightarrow c} \frac{(\eta(x))^\alpha}{b^\lambda \eta(x)} = 0 \quad \text{with } \alpha, \beta, \lambda > 0, a, b > 1$$

Example 2: Comparison of infinities

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \frac{\log\left(\frac{1}{x^2}\right)}{\frac{1}{x^2}} = 0$$

since, with $\eta(x) = \frac{1}{x^2}$, we have $\eta(x) \rightarrow +\infty$ as $x \rightarrow 0$.



Remark 1

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 0^+} x^\alpha \log_a^\beta x = 0 \quad (\alpha > 0, \beta = \frac{m}{n}, n, m \in \mathbb{N}, n \text{ odd}, a > 1)$$

Proof. Given $\alpha, \beta > 0, a > 1$ we have:

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{\log_a^\beta x}{x^\alpha} = 0 \quad \text{and} \quad \frac{\log_a^\beta x}{x^\alpha} = \left(\frac{1}{x}\right)^\alpha \left(-\log_a\left(\frac{1}{x}\right)\right)^\beta$$

Setting $t = \frac{1}{x}$, $x \rightarrow +\infty$ is equivalent to $t \rightarrow 0^+$, and substituting we have:

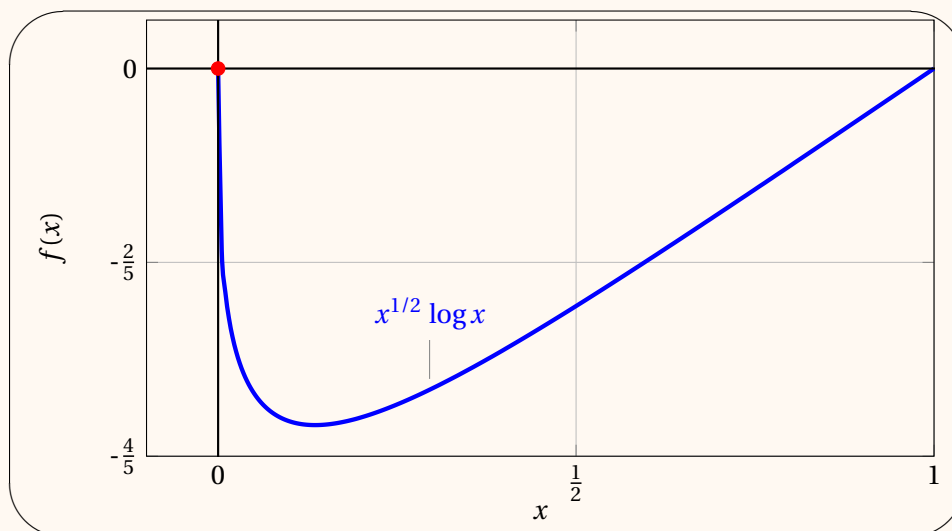
$$\lim_{x \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{\log_a^\beta x}{x^\alpha} = (-1)^\beta \lim_{t \rightarrow 0^+} t^\alpha \log_a^\beta t = 0$$

□

Example 3: Comparison of infinities

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 0^+} x^{1/2} \log x = 0^-$$

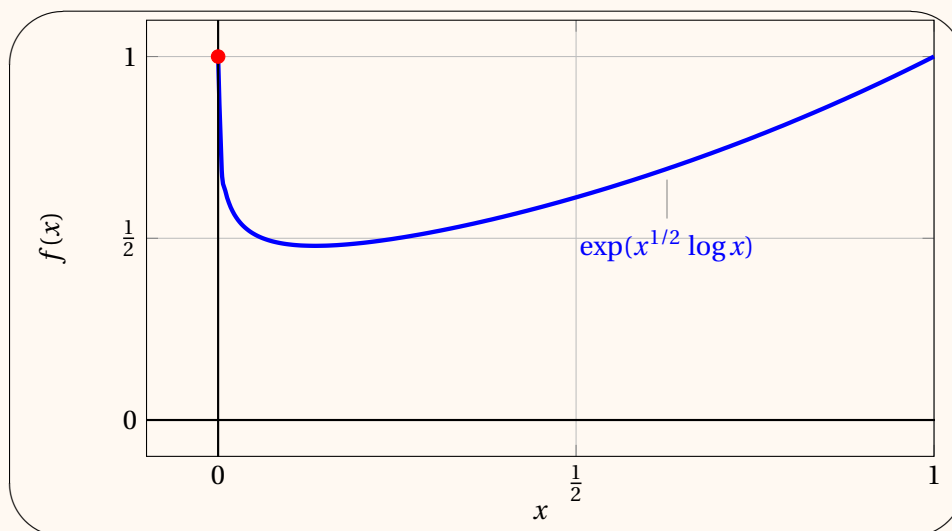
since we have $\alpha = \frac{1}{2} > 0, \beta = 1 > 0$ and $a = e > 1$.



$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 0^+} x^{\sqrt{x}} = 1^-$$

since

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 0^+} x^{\sqrt{x}} = \lim_{x \rightarrow 0^+} \underbrace{e^{x^{1/2} \log x}}_{=\exp(x^{1/2} \log x)} = e^{0^-} = 1^-$$



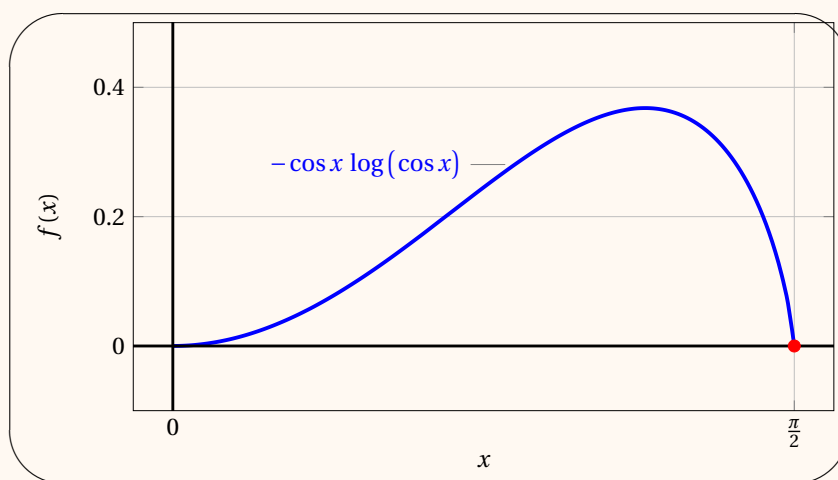
If a function $\varepsilon(x)$ tends to 0^+ as $x \rightarrow c \in \mathbb{R}^*$, it follows from the previous remark that:

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow c} (\varepsilon(x))^\alpha (\log_a(\varepsilon(x)))^\beta = 0 \quad (\alpha > 0, \beta = \frac{m}{n}, n, m \in \mathbb{N}, n \text{ odd}, a > 1)$$

Example 4: Comparison of infinities

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow \frac{\pi}{2}^-} -\cos x \log(\cos x) = 0^+$$

since, with $\varepsilon(x) = \cos x$, we have $\varepsilon(x) \rightarrow 0^+$ as $x \rightarrow \frac{\pi}{2}^-$ and $\alpha = \beta = 1$.



From the comparison of infinities theorem it follows that:

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{x^\alpha}{\log_a^\beta x} = +\infty \quad \text{and} \quad \lim_{x \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{b^{\lambda x}}{x^\alpha} = +\infty \quad \text{with} \quad \alpha, \beta, \lambda > 0, \quad a, b > 1$$

Remark 2

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 0^+} x^\alpha b^{\lambda/x} = +\infty \quad (\alpha, \lambda > 0, \quad b > 1)$$

Proof. Given $\alpha, \lambda > 0, b > 1$, we have:

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{b^{\lambda x}}{x^\alpha} = +\infty$$

Setting $t = \frac{1}{x}$, $x \rightarrow +\infty$ is equivalent to $t \rightarrow 0^+$, and substituting we have:

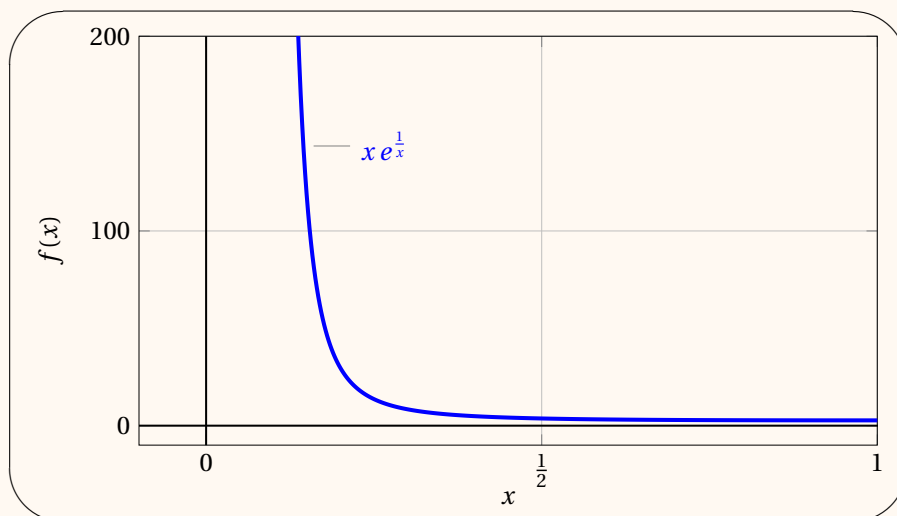
$$\lim_{x \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{b^{\lambda x}}{x^\alpha} = \lim_{x \rightarrow +\infty} \left(\frac{1}{x}\right)^\alpha b^{\lambda x} = \lim_{t \rightarrow 0^+} t^\alpha b^{\lambda/t} = +\infty$$

□

Example 5: Comparison of infinities

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 0^+} x e^{\frac{1}{x}} = +\infty$$

since we have $\alpha = \lambda = 1$ and $b = e > 1$



Remark 3

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 0^+} x^{-\alpha} b^{-\lambda/x} = 0 \quad (\alpha, \lambda > 0, b > 1)$$

Proof. Given $\alpha, \lambda > 0, b > 1$ we have:

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{x^\alpha}{b^{\lambda x}} = 0$$

Setting $t = \frac{1}{x}$, $x \rightarrow +\infty$ is equivalent to $t \rightarrow 0^+$, and substituting we have:

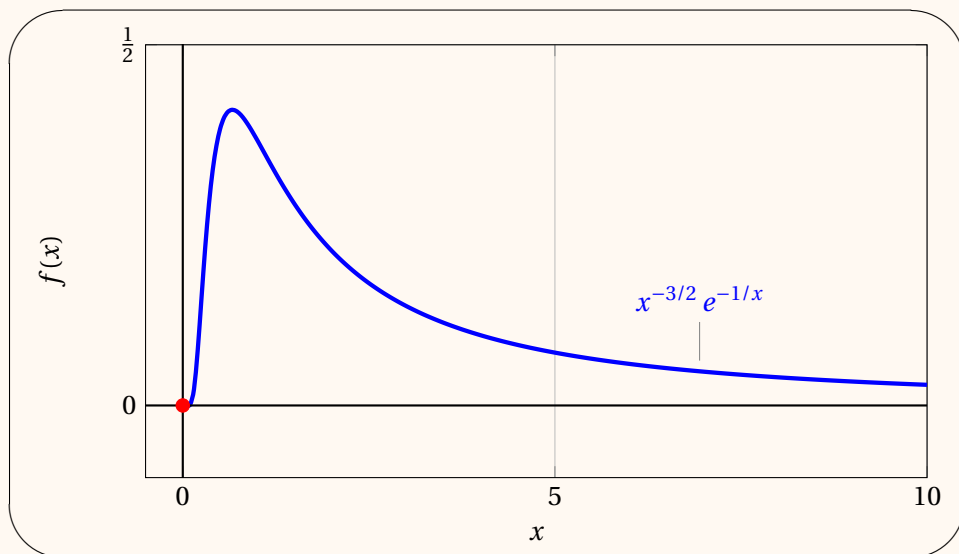
$$\lim_{x \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{x^\alpha}{b^{\lambda x}} = \lim_{x \rightarrow +\infty} \left(\frac{1}{x}\right)^{-\alpha} \frac{1}{b^{\lambda x}} = \lim_{t \rightarrow 0^+} t^{-\alpha} b^{-\lambda/t} = 0$$

□

Example 6: Comparison of infinities

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 0^+} x^{-3/2} e^{-1/x} = 0$$

since we have $\alpha = \frac{3}{2}, \lambda = 1$ and $b = e > 1$.



Remark 4

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} x^\alpha b^{\lambda x} = 0 \quad \left(\alpha = \frac{m}{n} > 0, n, m \in \mathbb{N}, n \text{ odd}, m \neq 0, \lambda > 0, b > 1 \right)$$

Proof. Given $\alpha, \lambda > 0, b > 1$ we have:

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{x^\alpha}{b^{\lambda x}} = 0$$

Setting $t = -x$, $x \rightarrow +\infty$ is equivalent to $t \rightarrow -\infty$, and substituting we have:

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{x^\alpha}{b^{\lambda x}} = \lim_{t \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{(-t)^\alpha}{b^{-\lambda t}} = (-1)^\alpha \lim_{t \rightarrow -\infty} t^\alpha b^{\lambda t} = 0$$

□

Example 7: Comparison of infinities

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} x^2 e^x = 0$$

since we have $\alpha = 2, \lambda = 1$ and $b = e > 1$.

